



*humps contain
reserves of fat*

distinctive second hump

elbow pad

*belly needs little
protection from
sunburn, so the coat
here is thin, allowing
heat to be shed*

knee pad

^ DESERT TRAVELS

Camels are long-legged nomads, able to travel 50 km (30 miles) a day and go without water for a week or more. This extraordinary resilience makes them ideal beasts of burden in arid areas. Bactrian camels eat a wide range of plant foods, and have a large stomach with three chambers in which tough food is slowly broken down. In undernourished camels, the humps become floppy as the reserves of fat are used up.

paired toes